

AWS Shared Responsibility Model

Security OF the Cloud

Security OF the Cloud refers to AWS’s responsibility to protect the underlying infrastructure that runs all AWS services. This includes physical data centers, hardware, networking, and the software that runs AWS services. AWS ensures that the cloud infrastructure is secure, resilient, and properly maintained.

Security IN the Cloud

Security IN the Cloud refers to the customer’s responsibility to secure what they deploy on AWS. This includes protecting data, managing user access (IAM), configuring security groups, patching operating systems, and securing applications and workloads. Customers secure what they put into the cloud.

Shared Responsibility Table

AWS Responsibility	Customer Responsibility
Physical data centers and hardware security	Data encryption and data protection
Networking and infrastructure management	Identity and Access Management (IAM)
Hypervisor and virtualization layer	Operating system patching and updates
Availability Zones and Regions	Application security and configuration
Managed AWS service security	Firewall rules and security groups configuration
Training AWS employees	Training customer employees

#	Item	Responsibility	Shared Controls
1	Physical server hardware	AWS	
2	EC2 operating system patches	Customer	
3	S3 bucket access policy	Customer	
4	Data centre cooling & power	AWS	
5	IAM user passwords & MFA	Customer	
6	Network firewall between AZs	AWS	
7	Encrypting data stored in S3	Customer	
8	Who can access your AWS account	Customer	
9	SSL certificate on your web app	Customer	
10	Hypervisor (virtualisation layer)	AWS	
11	Database backups on RDS (managed)	AWS	
12	Database backups - MySQL running on EC2	Customer	
13			Patch Management (AWS patches host; Customer patches guest OS)
14			Configuration Management
15			Security Awareness Training

AWS Shared Responsibility Model — My Summary

Mafulul Mangut – 24 May 2026

AWS Responsibility	Shared Controls	Customer Responsibility
Physical server hardware	Patch Management (AWS patches host; Customer patches guest OS)	EC2 operating system patches
Data centre cooling & power	Configuration Management	S3 bucket access policy
Network firewall between AZs	Security Awareness Training	IAM user passwords & MFA
Hypervisor (virtualisation layer)		Encrypting data stored in S3
Database backups on RDS (managed)		Who can access your AWS account
		SSL certificate on your web app
		Database backups – MySQL running on EC2

3 Sentences Explaining the Shared Responsibility Model to a Non-Technical Business Owner

Target audience: A Lagos restaurant owner who is considering moving their POS system and customer data to the cloud.

1. AWS secures the physical infrastructure of the cloud, like servers, storage, and data centres.
2. You are responsible for protecting your own data, controlling who can access your POS system, and keeping passwords and applications secure.
3. This matters because AWS provides a secure foundation, but your restaurant must still manage staff access and protect customer payment data, since failing to secure your side could expose your POS system and records even if AWS does its part.